

# Game Design Document

[Game Title]

[Author / Team]

[Date]

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# **1 Game Overview**

## **1.1 High Concept**

[Describe the game in one or two sentences.]

## **1.2 Design Pillars**

- Pillar 1: the core experience the game should deliver.
- Pillar 2: another principle that guides design decisions.
- Pillar 3: a quality that makes this game distinctive.

## **1.3 Target Audience and Platform**

[Describe the intended players, platforms, and target session length.]

# **2 World and Story**

## **2.1 Setting**

[Describe when and where the game takes place.]

## **2.2 Premise and Narrative**

[Summarize the story, its central conflict, and how it is delivered to the player.]

## **2.3 Characters and Factions**

[List the important characters or groups and their roles.]

# **3 Gameplay**

## **3.1 Player Goals**

[Explain the player's short-term and long-term objectives.]

## **3.2 Core Gameplay Loop**

[Describe the actions players repeat during a typical play session.]

## **3.3 Game Modes and Progression**

[Outline available modes, milestones, unlocks, and how difficulty develops.]

# **4 Mechanics and Systems**

## **4.1 Core Mechanics**

[Describe the main player actions and the rules governing them.]

## **4.2 Controls**

[Add control mappings for each target platform.]

### **4.3 Resources, Items, and Abilities**

[Describe relevant resources, equipment, abilities, and their constraints.]

### **4.4 Failure, Recovery, and Rewards**

[Explain what happens when the player fails and how success is rewarded.]

## **5 Levels and Content**

### **5.1 Level Structure**

[Describe the structure, pacing, and variety of levels or missions.]

### **5.2 Challenge and Difficulty**

[Explain how challenges are introduced, combined, and tuned.]

### **5.3 Content List**

[List planned levels, missions, encounters, or other major content.]

## **6 Art and Audio Direction**

### **6.1 Visual Direction**

[Describe the visual style, palette, camera, and readability goals.]

### **6.2 Sound and Music**

[Describe the music, sound effects, and audio feedback priorities.]

## **7 User Interface and Accessibility**

### **7.1 Interface and Feedback**

[Describe the HUD, menus, onboarding, and feedback for player actions.]

### **7.2 Accessibility**

[List planned accessibility options and readability considerations.]

## **8 Technical and Production Plan**

### **8.1 Technology and Requirements**

[Record the engine, tools, target hardware, and technical constraints.]

### **8.2 Scope and Milestones**

[Outline the prototype, production milestones, and planned release scope.]

### **8.3 Risks and Open Questions**

[Track unresolved design questions, dependencies, and production risks.]

## 9 Appendix

[Add references, terminology, mockups, diagrams, or change history.]